

PATNA | Food for Drought

The logic of Lalu Prasad Yadav never ceases to amaze. This time the Rashtriya Janata Dal chief has been quick to blame Chief Minister Nitish Kumar for the drought in Bihar. Lalu says the rains have given the state a miss because Kumar displeased the gods by going on a biscuit binge during last month's total solar eclipse. "His eating biscuits during the eclipse has cast an eclipse on food availability and rain in Bihar," Lalu said. Catering to the calls of the stomach during an eclipse is considered inauspicious. Twenty-six of the state's 38 districts, including Patna, have already been declared drought-hit after deficient rainfall during this monsoon left the state parched. Not only Bihar, the rest of the country is

KRISHNA MURARI KISHAN



LALU BLAMES KUMAR'S BISCUIT BINGE FOR THE DROUGHT IN BIHAR

struggling to come to terms with an indifferent monsoon and the inflationary impact on essential commodities. Kumar has rubbished Lalu's claim, calling him superstitious and irrational. Lalu's utterances always grab attention but this one just took the biscuit.

by Amitabh Srivastava

DELHI | Secret Saucer

Bring out the X-Files. For the second year running, Rajya Sabha member Rajkumar Dhoot has raised questions relating to Unidentified Flying Objects (UFO). The man in the spot both times, Minister of State Prithviraj Chavan. This year Dhoot asked Chauhan whether ISRO was aware of a UFO colliding with a Romanian airliner midair. Chavan's response was straight-faced again: ISRO is not aware of any such incident. Next year, everyone's betting on an actual UFO sighting.

by Sandeep Unnithan

IndianOil Golden Jubilee Celebration Free Fuel Round The Year Offer*



50

FIRST PRIZES
Branded Fuel worth
Rs. 25,000 each

50

SECOND PRIZES
Branded Fuel worth
Rs. 15,000 each

IndianOil

SAAL BHAR
FREE FUEL
OFFER

50

THIRD PRIZES
Branded Fuel worth
Rs. 5,000 each

1000

FOURTH PRIZES
Branded Fuel worth
Rs. 1,000 each

Drive into the nearest IndianOil, IBP or AOD outlet and

Fill Rs. 500 worth **XTRAPREMIUM**, **XTRAMILE** or **autogas** and win free fuel for a year*

SMS <IOC> <SPACE> <BILL NO.> to 53636



Offer valid till 30th September 2009.

For terms and conditions log on to www.iocl.com

*Conditions apply